7/10/2025 - Public Service Hearing - 25-E-0072, 25-G-0073

STATE OF NEW YORK

PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

CASE 25-E-0072 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Electric Service.

CASE 25-G-0073 - Proceeding on Motion of the Commission as to the Rates, Charges, Rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for Gas Service.

PUBLIC STATEMENT HEARING

DATE: JULY 10, 2025

LOCATION: C.W. Mixon Center
112-50 Springfield Blvd.
Queens Village, New York 11429

BEFORE: ALJ TARA KERSEY
ALJ DAKIN LECAKES

Reported by Ildiko Nyari

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(The hearing commenced at 1:01 p.m.)

A.L.J. KERSEY: On the record. I call case 25-E-0072, proceeding on motion of the Commission as to the rates, charges, rules and regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for electric service and case 25-G-0073 proceeding on motion of the Commission as to the rates, charges, rules and Regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York, Inc. for gas service.

Good afternoon. My name is Tara Kersey, and with me is Chief Administrative Law Judge Dakin Lecakes. I, along with two other judges at the Public Service Commission, have been assigned for the Department of Public Service to these rate cases. Chief Administrative Judge Lecakes is with me today to preside over this public statement hearing held on behalf of the New York State Public Service Commission regarding the proposed changes in the electric and gas delivery rates and practices of the Consolidated Edison Company of New York.

Con Edison filed amendments to its electric and gas tariff schedules on January 31st, 2025, proposing to increase its annual electric and

gas delivery revenues for the 12-month period ending December 31st, 2026.

As of its April 10th, 2025 updated testimony, Con Edison proposes to increase its electric delivery revenues by approximately $1.6 billion and its natural gas delivery revenues by approximately $349 million. The actual bill impacts of these proposed changes on any particular customer class will vary based upon revenue allocation and rate design.

At this point, I have canvased the audience and we do not have any members of the public in attendance. It is approximately 1:05 p.m. in the afternoon, and so we will leave this rate proceeding open until 1:30. And we're going to go off the record, unless we get any members of the public in the next -- in the upcoming minutes.

We are off the record.

(Off the record)

(On the record)

A.L.J. KERSEY: We are back on the record. I have called cases 25-E-0072 and 25-G-0073. These are the proceedings on the motion of the

Commission as to the rates, charges, rules and regulations of Consolidated Edison Company of New York for electric and gas service.

As I had said earlier, my name is Tara Kersey. And with me is Chief Administrative Judge Dakin Lecakes. We are here to hold this public hearing held on behalf of the New York State Public Service Commission, regarding the proposed changes in the electric and gas delivery rates and practices of the Consolidated Edison Company of New York.

Con Edison filed amendments to its electric and gas tariff schedules on January 31st, 2025. Con Edison is proposing to increase its annual electric and gas delivery revenues for the 12-month period ending December 31st, 2026. As of its April 10th, 2025 updated testimony, Con Edison proposes to increase its electric delivery revenues by approximately $1.6 billion and its natural gas delivery revenues by approximately $349 million.

The actual billing impacts of these proposed changes on any particular customer class will vary based upon revenue allocation and rate design. By letter dated June 24th, 2025, Con Edison

filed a notice of impending settlement negotiations involving all participating parties. If settlement negotiations are successful, the parties to the settlement would file a joint proposal to be considered by the Commission.

Under New York State law, the Public Service Commission must consider the utility's proposals and may adopt or reject them in whole or in part or modify them. At this time, the Commission must decide these cases by December 30th, 2025. However, that date may be subject to further extension.

Regardless of how these cases proceed, the Public Service Commission will make the final decision regarding the company's terms and conditions for providing electric and gas service. This hearing is being held so you can provide your comments on Con Edison's proposals for the Commission's consideration. In making its decision, the Commission will consider the evidentiary record in this case and the comments made at this hearing.

The Public Service Commission has seven members the chairperson, Rory Christian, and

six commissioners, James Alesi, David Valesky, John Maggiore, Uchenna Bright, Denise Sheehan and Radina Valova.

Statements you make today will become part of the record. The Court reporter here will prepare a transcript of the hearing, which will be included in the record of these proceedings, so that your comments can be considered by all members of the Commission. When it is ready, the transcript will be made available for public view on the Department of Public Service's website. Today's hearing is not a question-and-answer session. We are here only to hear your comments.

However, if you do have any questions or concerns related to your service, Con Edison has representatives here and they have materials on the side there, on the side table there, that provide a dedicated phone number and email for customers to get information related to specific customer service and billing inquiries. You can obtain these materials right there on the table. Those materials will help you get that specific customer assistance.

We here, have members of our Office of

Consumer Services, the Department of Public Service, where you have registered, if you've registered to make a comment, and they can assist you as well with questions or complaints regarding your utility service.

If you do not wish to speak at today's hearing, but you would like your views included in the record, there are other ways to comment. You can submit comments on the Department's website, by regular mail or by telephone. Information regarding these alternative methods is available from the Department's Office of Consumer Services staff, who are seated at this table right near the door.

Regardless of how comments are submitted, they will be given equal consideration by the Commission. According to the Secretary's notice for this event, comments must be received by November 21st, 2025 to ensure that the Commission is able to consider them prior to its final decision. If you would like to make a statement here today and you have not done so already, please fill out a registration card. The registration cards are available at the table with our outreach staff.

I will call speakers up one by one, using the cards in the order in which they were received. Please speak slowly and clearly so that the Court reporter can accurately capture your statement for the record.

Our first speaker is the Reverend Thorbs.

Take your time.

REV. THORBS: Good afternoon everyone. Thank you for being here. Thank you for having this -- having this situation here in the community and making it available.

What I'd like to say, I am Reverend Carlene Thorbs, and I am the chairperson of Community Board 12, first of all. So I speak as the chairperson for this District, and I also speak as a resident of this community. The increase that we are being told, at 11 percent, coming in January 2026 is astronomical. It is hurtful. Not only do -- are we concerned about our seniors who are homeowners and in this District, but we're also concerned about the families.

This will be such a burden and a heavy

lift, and it feels like it is being put on the shoulders of the middle class, the working families that now they may have to choose between paying a bill and buying groceries. And this is something that -- a pressure that we do not need.

To the powers that be that have control over this hike and this rate increase, we ask that you reconsider, because now, if anyone runs a household, whether in an apartment or in a or in a home, this rate is going to be a hit. And we understand that from the first rate increase. So we are imploring to you, Con Ed, and to our elected officials, to have this situation stand down and not increase at an 11 percent. If there was an increase and it had to be done, two percent is acceptable. From what I have seen in the news, they have accepted two percent in -- with other agencies in regards to a Con Ed. Increase. Why isn't this being done for the residents?

So again, on behalf of the residents of South Jamaica, Hollis, Saint Albans, and Jamaica, we ask that this increase not take place, that there will be a pause, a considerable pause, and go back

and reevaluate. Thank you.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Thank you for your comments.

Our next speaker is Vanessa Sparks.

MS. SPARKS: Good afternoon, and I'd like to thank Senator Leroy Comrie's office for putting this forum together in the community. As Rev. Thorp said, I too am a resident of Community Board 12. I live in Jamaica, New York. I am a homeowner. I am now also a senior. And this rate, this substantial rate increase is going to make it much more difficult for me to be able to pay my Con Edison bill.

I am a pensioner. I'm a retired New York State employee. I'm a pensioner. I live off a pension. I have other expenses, major expenses, and 11 percent is a substantial increase. I'm asking for a moratorium on this until Con Edison can provide, in writing in real language, everyday language, to customers the reason for such a substantial increase, because I have not heard or read anywhere to my satisfaction, why they are requesting such a substantial increase.

Additionally, I have not heard from Con Edison, any relief that would be offered up for homeowners that may have existing large bills once this takes place, to assist them to pay. So until Con Edison can provide its customers with a detailed real language explanation as to why they need an 11 percent increase, I'd ask the Public Service Commission to put a pause on this, a moratorium on this rate increase. Thank you.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Thank you. Thank you for your comments.

Are there any other speakers in the audience that would like to make a statement? If so, please fill out a registration card.

Our next speaker is Melissa Hubbard.

MS. HUBBARD: Thank you. Good afternoon. Members from the board who are here to conduct this public hearing. I also would like to thank Senator Comrie's office for providing this forum here in the community and also for the BlaQue Resource Network, who actually helped to spread the information within the community. It is unfortunate that as citizens, as residents of here in Queens, but

across the City and let alone the State, that it is -- we have to depend upon using social media. We also have to depend upon receiving information in a timely manner from our elected officials, but who we failed to receive information about these public hearings was from the Commission in advance, is unfortunate.

Instead, you want to inform residents about these latest increases at the last minute, and we're supposed to just kind of accept it, or what will be documented is the lack of representation that is able to attend these in-person public meetings. You have those who would love to be at an in-person meeting, but they may be currently at work. Because of what's happening with our economy, a lot of people are working two jobs. So just even having an in-person meeting, and in this day and age, not also offering a virtual opportunity is unacceptable, number one.

Now, I can say -- now, I actually represent as a member of not a Board member, but I am from Community Board 13. I actually live here in Queens Village and I am a resident. I'm going to say

and share my own personal story. So we've already received additional hikes from Con Edison. A lot of us were sharing through social media, as community representatives, talking amongst ourselves in our different meetings that we may attend, informing our elected officials, already how challenging it has been to deal with the increase in supply charges. Particularly, not just delivery charges, to be able to make ends meet by fulfilling our responsibilities to take care of our utility bills, our rents, our mortgage, you name it, take care of food, everybody is struggling.

And if it hadn't been for the help provided by my elected officials, I am somebody that due to I haven't been considered and labeled technically as a disabled person, but I am. I am a heart transplant survivor. I also suffer from a rare disease, and as a result, because of my health challenges, I'm not able to work the way I used to work. I am not considered fully a senior yet, but I am close to it and I have to work now remotely from home.

And as a result of my illness, I was

unable to even meet my utilities, my mortgage, and all the other expenses that everybody here deals with. And I had to get to the point of really being in need and applying for HEAP, and that was a hurdle that I finally got. I could reach out to Con Ed, I could make payment agreements, but as things continued to get worse, it was challenging. And it wasn't until I qualified for help that now, Con Ed was willing to work with me.

I represent somebody who is a highly educated person. I'm also somebody who has worked hard. But this is not only affecting those of us who may be middle class, may be professionals or homeowners, may be renters who are doing homes. These prices at this time, when we hear what's happening in the City, the State, and nationally, that there is a crisis of affordability, how dare Con Edison, at this time, want to do another rate increase?

I stand in agreement with the other members who have just spoke at this hearing, that there is a moratorium placed until, number one, Con Ed can share, in a timely fashion with all residents,

the reasons as to why to show justification not just with talk, by also showing the numbers as to why there is a need for another rate hike when they are already aware of the challenges that a lot of people are facing to pay their current bills.

With this current heat wave, there is a need for air conditioning, not just for seniors, but for anybody. It's needed for children. It's needed for families. It's needed for people with illnesses. That already is meaning an increase of your utility bills.

My Con Ed bill used to be in the summer, around 200 to $300, depending upon my use. My winter bills were that much. My fall bills were around 200 to $300. My spring bills were around to 200 to $300. And by the time this summer is finished, who knows what my monthly bills will be? People cannot afford, and so I am asking again that there is a moratorium. That more information is provided to the residents. And that also, that even should they determine that they want to have a rate hike, you need to offer more options so that people who are responsible and want to pay their bills also

have more options in terms of how to pay, to extend payment plans, to extend payment agreements make it more affordable. Because if I hadn't gotten as sick as I did and didn't need actual assistance, I wouldn't have had it. And I am just slowly getting back on my feet. But it comes with, of course, daily for my health.

And so I am a representative of all of those who may not be able to be here for whatever reasons, but are in the same position as I am. Highly educated, professional, not retired yet, living off of resources, maybe working remotely, can't work fully, but I still need to be able to maintain a roof over my head, have electricity in my house, be able to have gas, have oil, be able to buy food and everything else associated with living in today's economy. Thank you very much for listening.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Thank you. Thank you for your comments.

I have no other speaker registration cards. Is there anyone else who would like to speak this afternoon?

REV. THORBS: Are these the only

public hearings that Public Service Commission will be holding before the vote?

A.L.J. KERSEY: We have another public statement hearing here tonight at 6 p.m. But there is a process to how these cases proceed forward. So no, this isn't the only public statement hearing.

REV. THORBS: So if my community board requested, let's say in September, that someone from the Public Service Commission come and speak at our community board meeting, with the area that represents Jamaica, South Jamaica, St. Albans, Addesleigh Park, and Hollis, would that be possible?

A.L.J. LECAKES: So you can always go through the public affairs office for the New York State Public Commission and make requests for additional hearings, and they will be taken under consideration.

REV. THORBS: Thank you.

A.L.J. LECAKES: So yes, absolutely.

REV. THORBS: Thank you so much.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Certainly.

MS. SPARKS: And what was the name of that --

A.L.J. KERSEY: We're --

MS. SPARKS: -- that we can request --

A.L.J. KERSEY: We're going to -- let's just -- we're going to go off the record and we're going to hold this hearing open --

1:45 --

A.L.J. LECAKES: At a minimum -- at a minimum, to see if anyone else from the community comes this afternoon. So we're going to go off the record, but we can -- we can speak with you directly off the record.

REV. THORBS: Oh, we've got a chairperson. This is the chairperson for Community Board 12.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Okay.

REV. THORBS: And yes, you know, the summertime, many people are on vacation or they're just sort of clocked out so to speak.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Okay. Let's just -- we're just going to -- let's just go off the record so --

A.L.J. LECAKES: I thought we already were.

A.L.J. KERSEY: No, I don't think that --

REV. THORBS: But you can speak with her afterwards.

A.L.J. KERSEY: -- she's gone off the record. So yeah --

THE REPORTER: So we are going off the record.

A.L.J. KERSEY: Thank you.

(Off the record)

(On the record)

A.L.J. KERSEY: On the record. I have received no further speaker registration cards. And prior to going on the record, I polled those present to see if anyone interested intended to make a statement. No one has indicated a wish to speak. You may submit comments regarding these proceedings by the other means described earlier, even if you spoke today.

We'll have another hearing this evening at 6 p.m. Thank you for your participation today. The hearing is concluded, and we are off the record.

Thank you.

(The hearing concluded at 2:10 p.m.)

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STATE OF NEW YORK

I, ILDIKO NYARI, do hereby certify that the foregoing was reported by me, in the cause, at the time and place, as stated in the caption hereto, at Page 1 hereof; that the foregoing typewritten transcription consisting of pages 1 through 19, is a true record of all proceedings had at the hearing.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF, I have hereunto subscribed my name, this the 14th day of July, 2025.

ILDIKO NYARI, Reporter